

MIZORAM PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION
GENERAL COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION FOR RECRUITMENT TO THE POST OF
JUNIOR GRADE OF MIZORAM PLANNING, ECONOMIC & STATISTICAL SERVICE UNDER
PLANNING & PROGRAMME IMPLEMENTATION DEPARTMENT.
(DECEMBER, 2025)

GENERAL ENGLISH

Time Allowed : 3 hours

Full Marks : 100

Marks for each question is indicated against it.
Attempt all questions

1. Write an essay on **any one** of the following: **(20)**
- Youth and entrepreneurship in Mizoram: Barriers and the way forward.
 - Tourism as an Engine of Growth in Mizoram: Potential and Challenges.
 - Artificial Intelligence: A bane or a boon.

2. Write the precis of the following passage in about one-third of its original length. **(15)**

In the 21st century, technology has become an indispensable part of modern education, transforming the way knowledge is imparted and acquired. Traditional classrooms, which primarily relied on textbooks and chalkboards, are now being complemented or even replaced by digital tools such as computers, tablets, and interactive smart boards. This shift has not only made learning more engaging but has also enhanced the efficiency and reach of education. Students can now access vast resources online, ranging from e-books to video lectures and educational platforms, which supplement classroom teaching and encourage self-paced learning.

Technology has also broken geographical barriers, enabling education to reach remote and rural areas where conventional schools may be limited. Online courses, webinars, and virtual classrooms allow students to learn from experts worldwide without the constraints of location. During the COVID-19 pandemic, the importance of technology in sustaining education became particularly evident, as schools and universities successfully shifted to online learning, ensuring continuity despite physical closures.

Furthermore, technology fosters collaboration and interactive learning. Tools such as discussion forums, social media platforms, and group projects enable students to communicate ideas, share knowledge, and work collectively, thereby enhancing critical thinking and problem-solving skills. Teachers can also monitor student progress through learning management systems, track performance, and provide personalized feedback, making education more effective.

However, while technology offers numerous benefits, it also presents challenges. The digital divide means that students without access to devices or the internet may be left behind, exacerbating educational inequalities. Additionally, excessive reliance on technology can lead to reduced human interaction, affecting social skills and holistic development. Therefore, it is essential to integrate technology thoughtfully, balancing digital tools with traditional methods to create a comprehensive learning environment.

In conclusion, technology plays a pivotal role in modern education by making learning more accessible, interactive, and efficient. When implemented judiciously, it not only enhances knowledge acquisition but also equips students with the skills necessary for the digital age, preparing them for future challenges.

3. You are XXX, a resident of YYY Locality, Aizawl. The roads in your locality are full of potholes, making it difficult for pedestrians and vehicles to commute safely. Write a formal letter to the Executive Engineer, Public Works Department, Aizawl, requesting urgent repair and maintenance of the roads. **(10)**

4. Read the given passage carefully and answer the questions that follow:

A man or woman makes direct contact with society in two ways: as a member of some familiar, professional or religious group, or as a member of a crowd. Groups are capable of being as moral and intelligent as the individuals who form them; a crowd is capable of anything except intelligent action and realistic thinking. Assembled in a crowd, people lose their powers of reasoning and their capacity for moral choice. Their suggestibility is increased to the point where they cease to have any judgement or will of their own. They become very excitable, they lose all sense of individual or collective responsibility, they are subject to sudden excesses of rage, enthusiasm and panic. In a word, a man in a crowd behaves as though he had swallowed a large dose of some powerful intoxicant. He is a victim of what I have called 'herd poisoning'. Like alcohol, herd-poison is an active, extravagant drug. The crowd-intoxicated individual escapes from responsibility, intelligence and morality into a kind of frantic, animal mindlessness.

Unlike the masses, intellectuals have a taste for rationality and an interest in facts. Their critical habit of mind makes them resistant to the kind of propaganda that works so well on the majority. Intellectuals are the kind of people who demand evidence and are shocked by logical inconsistencies and fallacies. They regard over-simplification as the original sin of the mind and have no use for the slogans, the unqualified assertions and sweeping generalizations which are the propagandist's stock-in-trade.

- (a) Give a suitable title for the above passage. (2)
- (b) What is the main idea of the above passage? (2)
- (c) From your understanding of the passage, what is the behaviour of the crowd? (2)
- (d) How are the 'intellectuals' different from the 'masses'? (2)
- (e) What is the meaning of 'moral choice' and 'original sin' as used in the passage? (2)

5. Choose the correct type of clause for the words underlined in the given sentences: (5×1=5)

- (i) The student who topped the examination was given a scholarship.
 - (a) Adjective clause
 - (b) Adverb clause
 - (c) Noun clause
 - (d) Conditional clause
- (ii) She left the room quietly so that no one could notice her absence.
 - (a) Adverb clause
 - (b) Noun clause
 - (c) Adjective clause
 - (d) Independent clause
- (iii) Nobody knew where the treasure had been hidden.
 - (a) Adverb clause
 - (b) Noun clause
 - (c) Adjective clause
 - (d) Relative clause
- (iv) This is the reason why I refused the offer.
 - (a) Adverb clause
 - (b) Adjective clause
 - (c) Noun clause
 - (d) Subordinate clause of cause
- (v) He works as if he owned the entire company.
 - (a) Adverb clause
 - (b) Adjective clause
 - (c) Noun clause
 - (d) Comparative clause

6. Fill in the blanks by choosing the correct verbs: (5×1=5)

- (i) He, along with his friends, _____ to the conference tomorrow.
 - (a) are going
 - (b) is going
 - (c) were going
 - (d) have gone
- (ii) By the time we reach the station, the train _____ already left.
 - (a) has
 - (b) will have
 - (c) had
 - (d) would
- (iii) I'd rather you _____ the issue with anyone else.
 - (a) don't discuss
 - (b) didn't discuss
 - (c) not discuss
 - (d) didn't discussed

- (iv) He seems to have made little progress though he _____ hard.
(a) works (b) worked
(c) has worked (d) is working
- (v) The project _____ by the time the new director takes office.
(a) will complete (b) will have been completed
(c) was completed (d) had completed

7. Change the speech of the following sentences:

(5×1=5)

- (a) He said to his assistant, "Finish this report by tonight."
(b) She exclaimed, "How beautiful the night sky is!"
(c) He said to me, "Do it yourself if you want it done right."
(d) She said that she was going to submit the assignment the next day.
(e) He suggested that we start the meeting then.

8. Identify the Parts of Speech of the underlined words in the given sentences.

(5×1=5)

- (i) One should be careful about one's health.
(a) Preposition (b) Conjunction
(c) Noun (d) Adverb
- (ii) The wise king ruled for fifty years.
(a) Preposition (b) Conjunction
(c) Adjective (d) Adverb
- (iii) Julie is beautiful and rich; however she is not proud.
(a) Verb (b) Conjunction
(c) Noun (d) Adverb
- (iv) Hurrah! Our football team won the finals.
(a) Personal Pronoun (b) Indefinite Pronoun
(c) Interjection (d) Adverb
- (v) Joshua had borne the burden of keeping it a secret for a long time.
(a) Verb (b) Conjunction
(c) Noun (d) Adverb

9. Choose an appropriate preposition from the options provided at the end of each question.

(10×1=10)

- (i) Zorami lives _____ Aizawl _____ India.
(a) in / at (b) at / in
(c) in / in (d) at / at
- (ii) Pour the sugar _____ the cup.
(a) at (b) in
(c) into (d) over
- (iii) My mother has been sick _____ last week.
(a) from (b) since
(c) within (d) in
- (iv) The Kumar family will stay at the hotel _____ Sunday.
(a) at (b) since
(c) till (d) in
- (v) The man was sitting _____ a chair, basking in the sun.
(a) from (b) on
(c) within (d) in

- (vi) The students were beaten _____ a ruler.
(a) from (b) by
(c) within (d) with
- (vii) The Director told the clerk to put the files _____ the table.
(a) at (b) in
(c) from (d) on
- (viii) The teachers have been teaching _____ more than four hours.
(a) in (b) since
(c) for (d) from
- (ix) I hope to finish my work _____ evening.
(a) at (b) by
(c) within the (d) till
- (x) The tenants living _____ our floor are making too much noise.
(a) over (b) at
(c) above (d) from

10. Fill in the blanks with the correct forms of the verbs given in the brackets. Select the answer from the given options: **(5×1=5)**

- (i) Miss Sarah is the teacher who _____ (teach) us English.
(a) teach (b) teaches
(c) taught (d) is teaching
- (ii) I _____ (cross) the road when a man shouted at me to stop.
(a) cross (b) crosses
(c) crossed (d) was crossing
- (iii) He _____ (study) for hours before the exams.
(a) study (b) studied
(c) had studied (d) had been studying
- (iv) When we arrived, we _____ (find) the house deserted.
(a) find (b) have found
(c) found (d) did find
- (v) Sandra tells me that she _____ (finish) her work by the end of the week.
(a) finish (b) finished
(c) will finish (d) will be finishing

11. Change the sentence as directed: **(10×1=10)**

- (a) The family of the deceased believe that he is the killer. (Change the voice)
(b) His homework was being done by the computer. (Change the voice)
(c) He asked me if I will follow him till the end of his journey. (Change into interrogative sentence)
(d) How great is God! (Change into assertive sentence)
(e) Uncle John asked me if my father had left for office. (Change into interrogative sentence)
(f) Mary exclaimed in joy that she had cleared the exams with flying colours. (Change into exclamatory sentence)
(g) I will definitely reach your house at 9PM. (Change into negative sentence)
(h) Everyone wishes to attend an ivy league institution. (Change into complex sentence)
(i) Joshua is the man whom I am engaged to. (Change into simple sentence)
(j) He studied very hard. He studied for one whole week. He failed. (Change into compound sentence)